The timing of the Belgrade Summit was very crucial as it was marked by nuclear testing in France (1960–1961) by *Gerboise Bleue*, increased East–West tensions over Berlin, Laos, Cuba and the Congo. In the Belgrade Declaration, the NAM countries expressed their confidence in humanity to establish a peaceful world. They strongly opposed the existence of military blocs, which "necessarily provoke periodical aggravations of international relations" and sought peaceful coexistence to avoid the possibility of a nuclear disaster. They upheld the idea that peaceful coexistence was based on the rights of the people to self-determination, independence and the form of development of their own choice. NAM supported the UN Declaration on the Granting of Independence to Colonial Countries and Peoples and demanded an immediate stop to armed action and other repressions against liberation movements. The Conference condemned apartheid in South Africa, foreign intervention in Tunisia and the Congo, demanded restoration of all the rights of the Arab people of Palestine in accordance with the UN Charter and resolutions, and respect for Cuba's right to choose its own path of development. In sum, The Belgrade Declaration listed 27 separate items, 14 dealing with anti-colonialism, self-determination and non-interference, six relating to disarmament and three on economic development.

Apart from the Belgrade Declaration, on Nehru's suggestion, a separate Statement on the Danger of War and Appeal for Peace was approved. This was directed towards sending messages to the United States and the USSR to suspend their preparations for war in a nuclear age which might result in a total annihilation and start negotiations on disarmament.

Second NAM Summit, Cairo (Egypt), 5–10 October 1964

The second NAM Summit was attended by 47 states as compared to 25 in Belgrade. Of the 22 new members, 20 were African states. The number of observer states had increased from three to ten with the majority coming from Latin America and the Caribbean. The Movement stood strengthened by its increased membership and wider international representation.

The international scenario at this point of time was marked by the